3.2 The 90-Word Pitch - The Only Email That Matters

Elite private strategy - not for redistribution

WAR-ROOM NOTES - 3.2 The 90-Word Pitch

WHY 90 WORDS IS A WEAPON, NOT A FORMAT (ATTENTION ECONOMICS)

The PD's attention budget decays by the second. The first two lines decide open-or-scroll; the first 20 words decide read-or-skim; the first 90 decide reply-or-archive. An email over ~120 words requires the PD to opt in to reading - which virtually no stranger does. The 90-word structure is not artistic restraint; it's a tribute to the attention economy. You cannot win a battle in a 4-second window with a 400-word weapon.

THE PROOF-FIRST REORDER (HIDDEN TRICK)

Most artists open with their name and their music. The operator opens with the market's proof when it exists: "2,100 local streams this month" beats "I'm an artist" because it answers the risk question (Lesson 1.2) before the identity question. Only when your proof is weak do you lead with the human angle. But here's the unlock: the proof block is the block to personalize per station - the same pitch, different receipt, targeted to that market's data. Personalization ? flattery. Personalization = relevance.

THE ONE-ASK PRINCIPLE (NEVER VIOLATE)

A 90-word pitch with two asks ("play my song and check my Instagram and come to my show") is a zero-ask pitch. One ask, one answer, one next step. If the conversation advances, you get the second ask on the call (Module 5.1). Radio PDs are not deals to close in one email - they're customers to serve across 90 days.

THE ATTACHMENT TRAP

Never attach a folder, a 12-page press kit, or a video. Attach at most: one radio edit, one 90-second audio file, and a one-page EPK URL. If your EPK is a PDF that requires a download to evaluate, it's already failed. The one-page EPK (Lesson 3.3) is built to be a link - instant, mobile, gorgeous.

THE FOUR-SECONDS TEST (PERSONAL LITMUS)

Every launch, print your pitch, hold it at arm's length, and read it in four seconds. If you can't name the ask afterward, rewrite. This test catches 90% of the fluff that survives six revisions. It's brutal - and it's the standard.